

Nouns and verbs

Learner workbook

Choose the form that fits a sentence.

Understand the distinction

A noun can name a thing, action, or idea; a verb tells what happens or describes a state. Some words have the same spelling in both roles: a plan / we plan. Other families change form: a decision / decide.

Look at the sentence pattern. An article such as a often comes before a noun phrase. A subject often needs a verb. Endings can help, but they are not reliable rules for every word. Check an unfamiliar word in a dictionary.

Compare the patterns

NOUN

We made a decision.

Decision names the result.

VERB

We decided to wait.

Decided is the past-tense verb.

BOTH

We plan to discuss the plan.

The first plan is a verb; the second is a noun.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. We need to ___ today. (decision / decide)

A. decision

B. decisive

C. decide

2. Please make a ___ . (choice / choose)

A. choice

B. choosing

C. choose

3. Identify the verb: They work at a school.

A. They

B. school

C. work

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Which pair uses a verb and its related noun correctly?

- A. We discussion the problem. The discussion was useful.
- B. We discussed the problem. The discuss was useful.
- C. We discussed the problem. The discussion was useful.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. decide

To is followed by the base verb in this pattern.

2. A. choice

A introduces a noun phrase.

3. C. work

Work tells what they do.

4. C. We discussed the problem. The discussion was useful.

Discussed is the past-tense verb; discussion is the noun.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-06.html